

VENERA 13

Space probe

The spacecraft Venera 13 sent back the first colour pictures from the surface of Venus. Tinted yellow by sunlight shining through clouds, they reveal a barren, volcanic landscape (with parts of the spacecraft in the foreground). The temperature – hotter than an oven – and crushing pressure on Venus destroyed the probe two hours after it had landed.

DATA FILE



WEIGHT: 760 kg (1,675 lb)



DATE OF LAUNCH: 30 October 1981

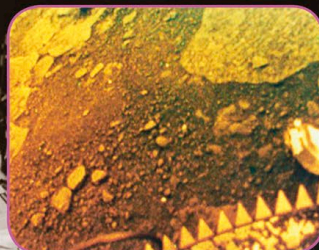


MISSION DURATION: 4 months, 2 days (last contact)



SPACE AGENCY: Russian space program

The probe survived long enough on Venus's surface to take 14 photographs.



Venus's surface as seen by Venera 13